

Self-Knowledge & Identity

Who are you as a player and as a person? In this session players discover their core values, what gives them energy and how others see them.

Group + individual

3 exercises

Evidence-based



What will you take with you today?

01

You can name **three core values** that define you as a person and teammate.

02

You recognise **what gives you energy** and what drains it in a team setting.

03

You understand the difference between **how you see yourself** and how others experience you.

Ntoumanis et al. (2021) — meta-analysis of 184 studies: autonomy and self-knowledge are the strongest predictors of sport motivation and wellbeing in young athletes. *Psychology of Sport & Exercise*.

Zuber & Conzelmann (2014) — 47 studies: intrinsic motivation and self-concept relate directly to sport performance in youth.

Deci & Ryan (1985, revised 2017) — Self Determination Theory: autonomy, competence and relatedness as universal basic needs for optimal development in sport.

Energy Giver vs Energy Drainer

What gives you energy during training and matches — and what drains it?

⚡ ENERGY GIVERS

Write 3 things that give you energy. Think: team spirit, a certain drill, a pre-match moment... Examples: 'When everyone cheers', 'A good warm-up', 'When the coach trusts me'

Write 3 things that drain your energy. This stays private unless you choose to share. Examples: 'When there is gossip', 'When I get no feedback', 'When I don't know my role'

Group talk (energy givers only): 'Which energy giver surprised you? How can we build it in more often as a team?'

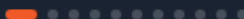
Choose your top 3 from 12 values — what truly drives you as an athlete and a person?

🏆 Loyalty · ✅ Honesty · 🛡️ Courage · 💪 Perseverance · 🙏 Respect · 🏆
 Team spirit · 🌱 Growth · 🎯 Focus · 🔥 Passion · 🤝 Responsibility · 💡
 Creativity · 🧘 Calm

'Which value did almost everyone choose? What does that say about our team?' · 'Give a real match moment where you saw this value.' · 'Which value is still missing in our team?' · 'If you lived your #1 value more tomorrow — what would you do differently?'

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 Notes

Kobe Bryant — 5x NBA Champion, Los Angeles Lakers

Tips for this session



Tip 1 — Be vulnerable yourself

Fill in the worksheet yourself and share your answers. The moderator's vulnerability lowers the threshold for players.



Tip 2 — Take notes

Note what players share. Use it later: 'You said courage mattered — I saw that in training today.'



Tip 3 — Little writing = OK

Players who write little aren't unmotivated. Self-knowledge can be confronting. Address it individually later.



Careful: pointing

NEVER ask 'Who wants to share?' and then point at someone. Start yourself, then volunteers. Build trust first.

10' min Exercise 1 — My Three Words (solo → pairs → group)

8' min Exercise 2 — Energy Giver vs Energy Drainer

12' min Exercise 3 — Value Compass + ranking on the board

5' Closing — quote + reflection + next month

Well done today.

You took the first step towards conscious character — that takes courage.

⚡ TEAM RITUAL · THE CIRCLE

● The Circle

Stand together in a circle. Each player says the name of one teammate + one word why they appreciated him/her today. Start yourself as moderator. Name + word — nothing more.

NEXT MONTH → PRESSURE & STRESS

Ask players to note one moment of stress over the coming week — on or off the field. They bring it to the next session.